

use an algorithm to guess the security key and pretend to be the other device.

9.3.2 Avoiding It

Securing your Bluetooth phone is easy. Take these few simple steps to ensure that your device is protected from Bluetooth attacks.

- Switch off Bluetooth when you are not using it. This will prevent unauthorised access for the most part. Only enable Bluetooth when you are actively transferring data from or to another device.
- Use a strong PIN code, one that is at least six to eight digits or longer.
- Many devices offer tons of features to maximise the usability of your Bluetooth connections. Review the documentation and disable all that are a security risk, and pay special attention to the security settings. Use encryption by default and only disable it if the device you are communicating with doesn't support it.
- Ensure that Bluetooth is running in hidden mode. When you are pairing it with another device, like a headset, you will need to run it in discoverable mode. Do this in a secure location like inside your office or home. Once the link has been established, go back to hidden mode. If for some reason the pairing breaks when in a public place, wait till you are in a secure location before re-pairing the two devices.
- Be aware of where you are. If you are in an open, public place, it is best to disable Bluetooth. Public wireless hotspots are a favourite hangout of "Bluejackers".